Gielo Joseph Fernandez

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Visa: Post Study Work Visa (Until May 2029)

Professional Summary

- Technical Solutions Engineer with 6+ years of experience in software development, API integration, and test automation across enterprise platforms and financial services. Strong background in REST APIs, webhooks, and debugging complex integrations. Experienced in building automation scripts and internal tooling to replace manual processes. Comfortable being the technical point of contact for partners and customers, explaining technical concepts clearly. Proficient in Python, TypeScript, and AI tooling. Full NZ work rights until 2029. Available to start with 2 weeks notice.

Key Highlights

- **Technical Impact:** 20+ hours saved per week via automation — 4x performance improvement — 10+ hours saved per release
- **API & Integration:** REST APIs, GraphQL, Webhooks, Third-Party Integrations, Debugging Complex Systems
- **Automation & Scripting:** Python, TypeScript, ETL Pipelines, AI-Assisted Automation, Internal Tooling
- **Customer-Facing:** Technical Partner Support, Integration Debugging, Clear Written Communication
- **AI-First Mindset:** GitHub Copilot, Replit AI, ChatGPT/Claude, AI Agents, Agentic Workflows
- **Availability:** Available to start in 2 weeks — Full NZ work rights until 2029

Experience

- **Manulife / John Hancock** — Makati, Philippines
  Full Stack Software Engineer — *Aug. 2021 – Sept. 2024*
  - **API Integration & Partner Support**: Integrated with third-party systems and APIs, debugging complex issues across microservices. Served as technical point of contact for stakeholders, explaining technical concepts clearly.
  - **End-to-End Testing (Insurance Platform)**: Tested online quote-and-bind journeys end to end for a transactional insurance platform serving 10,000+ policyholders. Covered rating, underwriting rules, referral triggers, workflows, and document outputs.
  - **Test Plan Development & Execution**: Designed comprehensive test plans and test cases covering functional, regression, integration, and release testing.
  - **API Testing & Integration**: Tested REST APIs and GraphQL services at enterprise scale, verifying raw payloads and third-party integrations. Ensured data integrity and correct behaviour across microservices.
  - **Defect Tracking & Resolution**: Identified, documented, and tracked defects through to resolution, retesting fixes before release.
  - **Test Automation**: Implemented a WebDriverIO-based test automation framework, reducing manual regression testing by 10+ hours per release.
  - **Agile Leadership**: Served as acting Scrum Master for a cross-functional team, facilitating sprint planning and retrospectives.
  - **Requirements Gathering & Stakeholder Management**: Collaborated with product, design, and business stakeholders to translate requirements into test scenarios and technical solutions.
- **Orcas Consulting Ltd.** — Raglan, New Zealand
  Software Engineer Intern — *Nov. 2025 – Feb. 2026*
  - **Industrial Data Platform (Time-Series Analytics)**: Built a data platform for marine location analytics, processing time-series tidal data for forecasting applications serving fishermen and surfers. Available at: https://www.rippleforecast.com/tide

- **Data Engineering & ETL Pipelines**: Engineered Python-based ETL pipelines to scrape and process structured data from third-party sources, eliminating 20+ hours of manual collection.
- **Optimized Map function loading speed by 4x**: Optimized data visualization by implementing Map Marker Clustering, achieving 4x faster rendering for thousands of real-time data points.
- **Reduced File Storage Size by over 90%**: Converted large time-series GEO-JSON datasets into compressed ZARR format, reducing storage by 90% and improving retrieval efficiency for time-based queries.
- **AI-Assisted Development & Testing**: Leveraged Replit AI and GitHub Copilot to accelerate development and testing cycles, cutting prototype turnaround times by 40% and improving test automation efficiency for cloud-based features.

- **Denso Ten Solutions** — Pasig City, Philippines
  Software Quality Engineer — *Aug. 2018 – July 2021*
  - **Test Plan Development & Execution**: Designed and executed comprehensive test plans and test cases, ensuring 100% test coverage and compliance with functional safety requirements. Performed functional, integration, regression, and system testing.
  - **Defect Tracking & Reporting**: Identified, documented, and tracked defects using system log analysis and raw data inspection. Provided clear, evidence-based feedback to developers for timely resolution.
  - **Test Automation**: Engineered MATLAB-based scripts to automate test input generation, improving test coverage and verification accuracy by 30%.
  - **Quality Documentation**: Authored comprehensive test documentation and system configuration guides, reducing troubleshooting times by 40%.
  - **Client Communication & Documentation**: Communicated with international clients and prepared technical reports in Japanese. Supported team onboarding through comprehensive training materials.

- **Evidentful** — Cromwell, New Zealand
  Junior AI Engineer Intern — *Dec. 2024 – Mar. 2025*
  - **AI-Powered Testing & Search Solutions**: Built proof-of-concept for AI-powered search using hybrid keyword and vector retrieval. Applied AI-driven approaches to data discovery and natural language query processing, demonstrating ability to work with AI/agentic technologies.
  - **Data Processing Workflows**: Implemented vector search workflows to improve the system's ability to process and retrieve information from natural language queries.
  - **Containerization & Deployment**: Containerized applications using Docker to ensure consistent development, testing, and deployment environments across internal projects.

Projects

- **RippleForecast Tides (Internship Project, 2026)**: Built a time-series data platform processing tidal data for forecasting applications. Engineered Python ETL pipelines, optimized large datasets, and delivered real-time visualizations. https://www.rippleforecast.com/tide
- **CoverMe Travel Insurance (Enterprise Project, 2023)**: Full-stack transactional platform with React/TypeScript frontend serving 10,000+ policyholders. Implemented responsive UI, state management, and performance optimization. https://www.coverme.com/travel-insurance/get-a-quote
- **SQL Analytics Dashboard (Personal Project, 2026)**: Designed relational databases and built interactive dashboards using Streamlit for data visualization. https://gielofernandez-sql-project.streamlit.app/

Education

- **Future Skills Academy International** — Auckland, New Zealand
  Master of Applied Management; Major in Business Information Systems — *Oct. 2024 – Apr. 2026*
  - **Relevant Coursework**: Business Analytics, Information Systems Strategy, Data-Driven Decision Making, Project Management

- **University of Santo Tomas** — Manila, Philippines
  Bachelor of Science in Computer Science — *June 2012 – July 2017*
  - **Relevant Coursework**: Data Structures & Algorithms, Software Engineering, Database Systems, Operating Systems, Object-Oriented Programming

Technical Skills

- **API & Integration**: REST APIs, GraphQL, Webhooks, Third-Party Integrations, Debugging Complex Systems
- **Programming & Scripting**: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, C, C++ (working knowledge), Java (working knowledge)
- **Automation & Tooling**: ETL Pipelines, Automation Scripts, Internal Tooling, CI/CD Pipelines, Docker, Git
- **AI & Agentic**: GitHub Copilot, Replit AI, ChatGPT/Claude, AI Agents, Agentic Workflows
- **Customer-Facing**: Technical Partner Support, Integration Debugging, Clear Written Communication
- **Testing & QA**: Manual Testing, Automated Testing, Regression Testing, Integration Testing, REST API Testing, Defect Tracking
- **Databases**: SQL Server, T-SQL, Stored Procedures, Query Optimization, NoSQL, CosmosDB
- **Cloud & DevOps**: Microsoft Azure (AZ-900 Certified), Docker, Git, CI/CD Pipelines
- **Methodologies**: Agile, Scrum (Scrum Master), Jira, Confluence, Full SDLC

Certifications & Languages

- **Certifications:** Datacamp AI Fundamentals (2025), Microsoft Certified Azure Fundamentals AZ-900 (2023), AutoCAD Training (2018)
- **Languages:** English (Fluent), Japanese (JLPT N4), Korean (Basic)